Richard “Dick” DeLuna

August 4, 1938 – October 14, 2026



What an Incredible Ride!

Richard “Dick” DeLuna passed away on October 14, 2026, at the age of 88, leaving behind an incredible family, lifelong friendships, and countless memories from a life filled with adventure.

Known as Amor Sumerce, Dad, Dick, Dicky, Mr. D, Tata, Papa, and “Papa Cars,” he was a man with endless energy, a generous heart, and a tremendous enthusiasm for life. His philosophy was simple: “Work hard, play hard.” He certainly did both.

Born in San Jose, California, to Matthew and Florence DeLuna, Dick grew up in Salinas, attended Palma High School, and spent his summers in Santa Cruz. Following high school, he joined the United States Air Force, serving in Fairbanks, Alaska. He later attended Cal Poly San Luis Obispo before joining the Peace Corps - an adventure that would change his life forever.

While serving in Colombia, Dick met the love of his life, Matilde. They married on May 23, 1964, in Pamplona, Colombia, beginning a wonderful marriage that lasted more than 62 years. Their first son, Mark, was born in Colombia before they returned to California to build their family and life together.

Dick was a proud father and even a prouder grandfather; above all else he loved his family. He took tremendous pride in his children and the families they built, but his grandchildren and great-grandchildren brought him an entirely new level of happiness. He loved watching them grow, celebrating their accomplishments, and sharing in their lives.

Family gatherings and trips to Lake Tahoe, Italy, and Alaska created lasting memories. Dick and Matilde also traveled extensively throughout the world, embracing new experiences, exploring different cultures, and making friends wherever they went.

Dick is survived by his beloved wife, Matilde, and his seven children and their spouses: Michael Gannotti (Tracy), Mark DeLuna (Jessica), Shawn DeLuna (Michele), Jennifer Costanzo (Brian), Christopher DeLuna (Elena), Jonathan DeLuna (Christine), and Richard DeLuna II (Kerstin).

He also leaves behind 17 grandchildren and six great-grandchildren, with a seventh on the way, his sister Barbara Lazarotti, sister-in-law Joyce DeLuna, and many nieces and nephews. He was preceded in death by his parents, brother Peter DeLuna, and brother-in-law Loren Lazarotti.

Dick had a remarkable ability to make friends wherever he went. To many of his children's friends, he was a second father, mentor, and lifelong friend. He loved bringing people together, sharing stories, and enjoying good company.

A respected and familiar figure in the San Mateo community, Dick was a member of the San Mateo Rotary Club for nearly 60 years, supported Saint Mary's College of California, the San Mateo County Historical Association, Junípero Serra High School, and Boy Scouts of America Troop 42. Scouting became a family tradition, with five of his sons and five grandsons earning the rank of Eagle Scout.

After beginning his career with Pacific Bell, Dick purchased County Credit Control and grew it into Collection Bureau of America, a nationwide business. He was also involved in the founding of Borel Bank. He valued his employees and the lasting relationships he developed throughout his career.

Cars were one of Dick's greatest passions. He loved collecting, restoring, showing, racing, and sharing his enthusiasm with friends and the next generation. There was always another car to work on, another project to finish, and another adventure waiting.

His passion took him around the world, racing La Carrera Panamericana, Mille Miglia, Targo Florio, Tour de Espana, Classic Safari Challenge and The Monterey Historics, he participated in numerous concourses and other historic races and rallies both in the US and in other parts of the world. A proud member of the Bay Area Roadsters, and countless other clubs Dick especially treasured the friendships and memories made along the way. But most of all his favorite navigator and partner for events near and far was Matilde. We still don't know how she could knit while he was driving over 100mph!

Dick lived life on his own terms, always looking forward to the next adventure.

One of his favorite quotes was:

Life's Journey….

Is not to arrive at the gates of heaven,

Safely in a well preserved body,

But rather to skid in sideways,

Totally worn out, shouting,

"HOLY SHIT, WHAT A RIDE!"

We can only imagine the wonderful welcome waiting for Dick in heaven, surrounded by the love and laughter of all the family and friends who went before him. What a reunion that must be, with familiar faces, old stories, and friendships picking up right where they left off.

Godspeed, Amor, Dad, Mr. D, Tata, Papa, and Papa Cars.

Funeral Services

October 27, 2026

St. Bartholomew Catholic Church
300 Alameda de las Pulgas, San Mateo, CA 94402
11:00 am Viewing
12:00 Mass

In lieu of flowers please consider donating to either your own favorite charities or one of Dick's.

San Mateo Rotary Scholarship Foundation.
https://4agc.com/donation_pages/bc3ae754-e7e4-486b-bc23-0064eb2daf1b

Junipero Serra High School
https://www.serrahs.com/support-serra/online-giving

San Mateo County Historical Society
https://historysmc.org/

Palma High School
https://palmaschoolfoundation.app.neoncrm.com/forms/palma-fund-ask